Cyber Insurance Application

Applicant: **Northwind Logistics Ltd**

Sector: Logistics and warehousing | Employees: 850 | Annual revenue: £140m

Prepared for underwriting review via Meridian Risk Partners (broker)

Submission reference: NWL-CY-2026-0417

1. Business and IT overview

The applicant operates a distributed IT estate spanning head-office corporate systems, regional depot infrastructure, and a growing set of cloud-hosted applications. The information below is provided in good faith to support the underwriting assessment and reflects the environment as at the date of submission.

Responsibility for information security sits with the Head of IT, who reports to the Chief Operating Officer. Security operations are delivered through a combination of an in-house team and a managed service provider engaged for out-of-hours coverage. Formal security governance is reviewed by a quarterly risk committee.

The organisation has grown through acquisition over the past five years, and a programme of estate consolidation remains in progress. Some legacy systems inherited through those acquisitions are still being migrated or decommissioned under the current roadmap.

The applicant provides third-party logistics, warehousing and last-mile distribution across the UK and Ireland, operating fourteen depots and two automated distribution centres. Core business applications include a warehouse management system, a transport management system, and Microsoft 365 for collaboration and email.

The corporate environment is predominantly cloud-hosted on Microsoft Azure, with residual on-premises systems at the two automated distribution centres supporting conveyor control and depot-floor terminals.

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2. Data handled

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The applicant processes customer contract data, driver and employee personal data, and limited payment-card data handled entirely through an outsourced, PCI-DSS compliant payment processor. The estimated volume of personal records held is between 500,000 and one million.

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3. Access control and authentication

The applicant operates a distributed IT estate spanning head-office corporate systems, regional depot infrastructure, and a growing set of cloud-hosted applications. The information below is provided in good faith to support the underwriting assessment and reflects the environment as at the date of submission.

3.1 Is multi-factor authentication enforced for remote access to the corporate network (VPN and remote desktop gateways)?

> **Response:** Yes. All remote access to the corporate network via the VPN and the remote desktop gateway requires multi-factor authentication using an authenticator application. Remote Desktop Protocol is not exposed directly to the internet.

3.2 Authentication for messaging and administrative accounts is addressed separately in Section 4 (messaging) and Section 8 (privileged access).

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4. Messaging and email security

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4.1 Is multi-factor authentication enforced for web-based email access for all users?

Response: Not at present. Multi-factor authentication for Microsoft 365 web mail is in pilot with the IT department; a phased rollout to all users is planned for Q3 but is not yet scheduled or enforced organisation-wide.

4.2 Do you operate email filtering and anti-spoofing controls?

Response: Yes. Inbound email is filtered for malicious attachments and links, and a DMARC policy is published at quarantine.

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5. Data protection and backup

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5.1 Describe your backup arrangements.

> **Response:** Critical systems and data are backed up nightly and replicated to a second Azure region. Backup copies are held under a WORM retention lock with a 35-day retention window, and backup data is encrypted at rest.

5.2 Backup recovery testing arrangements are described in Section 12 (business continuity and recovery).

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6. Endpoint security

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6.1 Do you deploy endpoint detection and response (EDR) across your estate?

> **Response:** Yes. Next-generation antivirus and EDR (CrowdStrike Falcon) is deployed across corporate laptops and desktops, covering approximately 92% of endpoints.

6.2 Are any devices excluded from EDR coverage?

> **Response:** Yes. Depot-floor terminals at the two automated distribution centres and two legacy servers on the warehouse network are not currently covered by EDR; remediation is on the roadmap.

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7. Network and perimeter controls

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7.1 Do you operate firewalls and network segmentation?

> **Response:** Yes. Perimeter firewalls are in place and the depot networks are segmented from the corporate environment. Segmentation of the warehouse control network is partial and under review.

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8. Privileged and administrative access

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8.1 How are administrator and privileged accounts managed?

> **Response:** Administrator accounts are separated from standard user accounts and are limited to named IT staff. A privileged access management tool has been scoped but not yet implemented.

8.2 Is multi-factor authentication enforced for administrator and domain-admin accounts?

> **Response:** Not currently. MFA is not yet enforced on administrator or domain-admin accounts, and dedicated privileged access workstations are not in use. This is identified as a priority remediation item.

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9. Legacy systems and patch management

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9.1 Do you operate any end-of-life operating systems in production?

> **Response:** Yes. Two Windows Server 2012 hosts remain in production on the warehouse control network pending migration, which is scheduled within the next financial year.

9.2 How quickly are critical security patches applied?

> **Response:** Critical patches are applied within 30 days of release where operationally feasible. Patching of the warehouse control systems is constrained by maintenance windows.

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10. Third-party and supply-chain risk

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10.1 Do you operate a formal third-party or vendor security assessment process?

> **Response:** No. Vendor security due diligence is currently carried out on an ad hoc basis; there is no formal, documented third-party security assessment process in place.

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11. Security awareness and training

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11.1 Do you provide security awareness training?

> **Response:** Yes. All staff complete annual security awareness training. The most recent simulated phishing exercise was conducted approximately 24 months ago.

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12. Business continuity and recovery

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12.1 When did you last test restoration of backups?

> **Response:** The most recent full restoration rehearsal on record was completed approximately 18 months ago. There is no scheduled recurring restore-testing cadence at present; establishing one is part of the current remediation plan.

12.2 Do you maintain a documented business continuity plan?

> **Response:** Yes. A business continuity plan exists and is reviewed annually.

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13. Claims and incident history

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13.1 Have you experienced any cyber incidents in the last three years?

> **Response:** One business email compromise attempt was detected in November 2024; no funds were lost and no data was exfiltrated. No insurance claim was made.

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14. Remediation roadmap

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The organisation has grown through acquisition over the past five years, and a programme of estate consolidation remains in progress. Some legacy systems inherited through those acquisitions are still being migrated or decommissioned under the current roadmap.

The applicant acknowledges a number of in-progress improvements, including enforcement of multi-factor authentication for email and privileged accounts, extension of EDR coverage to warehouse and legacy systems, migration of end-of-life servers, and the introduction of a formal vendor assessment process and a recurring backup restore-testing schedule.

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